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Give Claude access to the whole internet

A complete beginner's guide to Agent Reach: a free, open-source tool that lets Claude read YouTube, X, Reddit, LinkedIn, Instagram and more, without paying for API keys.

LEVEL	SETUP TIME	COST
Complete beginner	About 10 minutes	Free, open source

You need Claude Code (or another AI agent that runs in a terminal). One install command and you're done.

What this guide will help you do

Out of the box, Claude can't watch a YouTube video, scroll X, or read a LinkedIn company page. The official way to connect to those sites is through their **APIs**, which often cost money and take ages to set up.

Agent Reach fixes that for free. It's an open-source tool on GitHub that gives AI agents like Claude Code the ability to read and search the big platforms. Install it once, and you can say things like *"analyse this YouTube video"* or *"see what's trending on Instagram in my niche"*.

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What Agent Reach is

Agent Reach is a free tool (MIT licence) made by the developer **Panniantong**, and it's one of the most popular tools of its kind on GitHub. It isn't a new AI. It's like giving Claude a set of **eyes for the internet**: it installs and connects the tools Claude needs to read each platform, then tells Claude how to use them.

YouTube
Read a video's transcript and details, so Claude can summarise or analyse it.

X (Twitter)
Search posts and read threads to see what people are saying.

Reddit
Read discussions to find real questions, complaints and ideas.

LinkedIn and Instagram
Research companies, people and trends. These two need you to log in.

The list of supported platforms grows and changes. The project's README on GitHub always has the latest list.

What you need

YOU NEED	DETAILS
Claude Code	The **Code** tab in the Claude desktop app (claude.ai/download), included in Claude's paid plans. Any AI agent that runs in a terminal also works.
A computer	Windows, Mac or Linux.
The Agent Reach link	github.com/Panniantong/Agent-Reach
Your logins *(optional)*	Only for LinkedIn and Instagram, which don't show much to visitors who aren't logged in.

1 Open Claude Code

1 minute

1. Open the Claude desktop app and click the **Code** tab.
2. Start a new session, choose **Local**, and pick a folder, for example a new folder called `Research` in Documents.

2 Install Agent Reach

About 5 minutes

One message, and Claude does the whole install:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Install

```
Install Agent Reach from https://github.com/Panniantong/Agent-Reach

Read the README first and follow its install instructions exactly. I'm a beginner on Windows / Mac, so explain each step in one simple sentence before you do it.
When you're done, run its check command and show me a table of every platform: working / needs login / not working.
```

Claude will ask for permission to run commands. Read the explanation and click **Allow**.

3 Check what's working

1 minute

Do a quick real test:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Test

```
Use Agent Reach to read this YouTube video and give me a 5-bullet summary: ANY YOUTUBE LINK
```

If you get a summary of the actual video, it works.

4 Logging in to LinkedIn and Instagram

Only if you need them

LinkedIn and Instagram hide most things from people who aren't logged in, so for those two Agent Reach needs to use your login. Ask Claude to walk you through it:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Login setup

```
Walk me through connecting my LinkedIn / Instagram login to Agent Reach, the way its README recommends. Keep my login details stored only on this computer, and never print them in the chat.
```

Your login is like your password

Never paste your password into a chat, and never share login files or "cookies" with anyone. They give full access to your account. Keep them on your own computer only.

10 things to ask Claude

Once Agent Reach is installed, just ask normally. Here are ideas to start with:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Analyse a YouTube video

```
Analyse this YouTube video: LINK
Tell me: the hook in the first 10 seconds, the main points, how it keeps people watching, and 3 ideas I could use in my own content.
```

COPY THIS PROMPT — What's trending in my niche

```
Look at what's trending on Instagram in the YOUR NICHE niche this week. Find the topics, formats and hooks that are getting the most engagement, and give me 5 reel ideas based on them.
```

COPY THIS PROMPT — Competitor research

```
Research these companies on LinkedIn and their websites: COMPANY 1, COMPANY 2, COMPANY 3
For each: what they sell, who they target, how big they are, what they post about, and one weakness I could compete on. Put it in a table.
```

MORE IDEAS	ASK CLAUDE
Find content ideas	"Search Reddit for the questions beginners ask about topic. Group them and rank by how often they come up."
Know what people think	"What are people on X saying about product or topic this month? Summarise the positive and negative."

Study a creator	"Read the transcripts of the last 5 videos from `channel` and describe their style."
Validate a product idea	"Find complaints on Reddit about `existing products`. What do people wish existed?"
Prepare for a meeting	"Read `company`'s LinkedIn page and recent posts and give me a one-page brief."
Turn a video into a post	"Turn this YouTube video into a LinkedIn post in my own words: `link`"
Track a topic	"What's new about `topic` on X and Reddit in the last 7 days?"

The rules that keep your account safe

- **Don't scrape in bulk.** Reading a few pages for research is fine. Pulling thousands of profiles at once looks like a bot, and platforms ban accounts for it.
- **Never use the data for spam.** No mass messages, no bulk lists of people's details.
- **Respect privacy.** Research companies and public trends, not private individuals.
- **Read each platform's rules.** Free access works by reading the sites the way a browser does, not through their official paid APIs. Use it lightly, and the risk to your account is on you.

Fixes

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Claude says it can't access a site	Ask: "Run the Agent Reach check again and tell me what's wrong with `platform`." Often it just needs an update or a login.
LinkedIn or Instagram shows nothing	You need to log in for those two (Step 4).
"Command not found" after installing	Start a new Claude Code session in the same folder, or restart the app.
A platform stopped working suddenly	Sites change all the time. Ask Claude: "Update Agent Reach to the latest version."
Got blocked or asked to verify you're human	Stop for a day and use it more lightly. You're making too many requests.

Your checklist

- [ ] Claude Code is open in a folder
- [ ] Agent Reach is installed and the check shows which platforms work
- [ ] The YouTube test gave me a real summary
- [ ] I connected LinkedIn and Instagram (only if I need them) without pasting my password in the chat
- [ ] I tried at least 3 prompts from this guide
- [ ] I understand the rules: light use, no spam, no bulk scraping

Mini glossary

API	The official way for programs to get data from a site. Often paid.
API key	A secret password for using an API.
Open source	Free software whose code anyone can read and use.
GitHub stars	Like "likes" for code projects. Lots of stars means lots of people use it.
Scraping	Collecting information from websites automatically.
Terminal agent	An AI that works through commands on your computer, like Claude Code.

Claude can finally see the internet.

Use it to research smarter, not to spam harder. Your account will thank you.

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